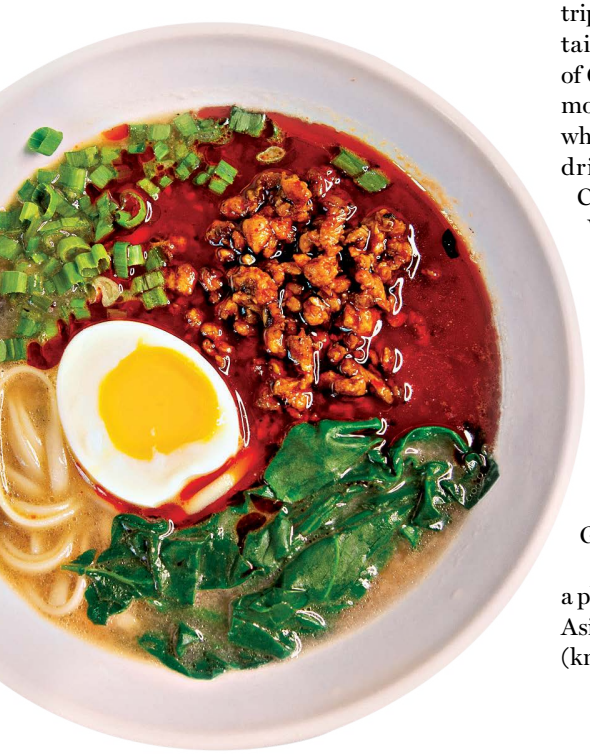


Siolim), Naga (Aal's Kitchen in Vagator), Mexican (Miss Margarita in Vagator), French (The Assa House in Assagao), Latin American (TeQuiero in Vagator), Burmese (SOPÓ in Assagao) and traditional Indian (Bawri in Assagao).

The profusion of people seeking workcations in Goa has led to a rise in cafés offering coffee with a side of networking. Café We, Babka and Grind Bar in Anjuna; Casa Café in Siolim; Mo's Café and Café Rasa in Panaji; Hello Sunshine, Bloom and Brew, Gshot Coffee Roastery & Café and Kefi in Assagao; and Barefoot Goa in Parra are just some of these cosy community spaces. Non-coffee drinkers can have high tea at Tea Trunk's experience centre in Fontainhas.

If you're looking for something stiffer, Goa has you covered. Besides a rise in homegrown and craft spirits—another pandemic effect—there are curated cocktail menus, pop-ups, bar takeovers and bar 'programmes'.

Restaurateurs are paying close attention to their bars, employing mixologists to create craft cocktails with in-house syrups and tinctures, using local ingredients and spirits. The award-winning Bar Tesouro (Colva) was once worth the trip to South Goa thanks to stellar cocktails from mixologist and co-founder of Countertop, Arijit Bose. He has now moved on, and has a laboratory space where he conducts intimate events (with drinks). Some standout bars include Candolim's Seven Rivers Brewing Co; Vagator's Half Pint serving a poee ale, Sylvia at W Goa with its gin menu and Idā; Ashwem's Amber Cocktail Bar' and Panaji's For the Record-Vinyl Bar, which uses mahua, urrak and other local liquors.



The Goan touch

The most heartening part of this F&B juggernaut has been the rise of Goan restaurateurs.

In Assagao, Avo's Kitchen is a rarity, a place serving Goan food. Nearby is the Asian Saké, by Adwalpalkar Hospitality (known for their Sinq brand); they have a yakitori bar in Siolim called Shiori. In Anjuna, Slow Tide is an attempt by some locals to redefine the shack experience.

The return of the prodigal Goan chef has given us The Village Bistro (Arpora) by Chef Gracian de Souza with its European fare and the fine-dine White Plate by Chef Jason de Souza (Candolim).

The two biggest successes of the post-Covid years have been two bakeries in Panaji that opened with no fanfare and whose popularity spread by word of mouth. Padaria Prazeres makes delicious pastries like pasteis de nata and berliners, while Larder & Folk has delectable cookies, and wholesome sandwiches.

Goa's capital, Panaji, features on every tourist's itinerary. Here, in a beautifully refurbished house, is where chefs